Jasper Götting

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About

I set out to become a zoologist but got massively derailed by impact-oriented cost–benefit analyses. After finishing my virology Ph.D. and exploring and evaluating technical biosecurity interventions, I now focus on solving AI–biosecurity.

Experience

Director of AI, SecureBio — July 2026 – present
- Leading SecureBio AI.

Head of AI Research, SecureBio — Jan 2026 – June 2026
- Led the 4-person research arm of SecureBio AI and coordinated research fellows.

Research Scientist, AI Team, SecureBio — May 2024 – Dec 2025
- First author of the Virology Capabilities Test (VCT). Led the development of SecureBio's evaluation dashboard and other AI benchmarks.

Research Fellow, Convergent Research — Sept 2022 – Oct 2024
- Roadmapping technical biosecurity interventions with a focus on far-UVC air disinfection (report), including organizing academic workshops, writing reports and recommendations, and interfacing with scientists, funders, and policymakers.

Research Contractor, Ellison Institute of Technology Oxford — May 2024 – Aug 2024
- Research on clinical MGS host nucleic acid depletion for EIT's Pathogen Mission.

Data Science Boot Camp, The Data Incubator at Data Reply, Munich — Feb 2018 – Mar 2018
- 8-week data science boot camp: SQL, web scraping, (un)supervised machine learning, deep learning, NLP, time series, MapReduce, and Spark
- Capstone project: identification of roof solar panels on satellite imagery using CNNs

Education

Ph.D. Virology, Hannover Medical School — Sept 2018 – June 2022
- Thesis at the Schulz Lab, Institute of Virology: "DNA viral genomic diversity data for epidemiologic and diagnostic studies"
- *Summa cum laude* (with distinction); Infection Biology Ph.D. Thesis Prize
- Student representative of the Infection Biology Ph.D. program

M.Sc. Biomedical Science, Hannover Medical School — Oct 2014 – Feb 2017
- Thesis at the Institute for Biophysics, University Osnabrück

B.Sc. Biology, Leibniz University Hannover — Oct 2011 – Sept 2014
- Thesis at the Neuroanatomy Institute, Hannover Medical School
- Teaching assistant in physiology; field assistant for a mouse lemur population study in northern Madagascar

Fellowships & Honors

Emerging Leaders in Biosecurity (ELBI) Fellow — 2026
Johns Hopkins Center for Health Security

Foresight Fellow — 2025
Foresight Institute

New European Voices on Existential Risk (NEVER) network member — 2023
European Leadership Network

Infection Biology Ph.D. Thesis Prize — July 2022
Hannover Biomedical Research School

Talks & Podcasts

AGI Safety and Trustworthy Alignment Roundtable — July 2026
Panelist, Scientific Frontiers Forum, World Artificial Intelligence Conference (WAIC) 2026, Shanghai

Biotechnology and Artificial Intelligence: Risks Posed by Research to Security and Biological Weapons Proliferation July 2026
Expert input, public expert discussion of the German Bundestag with its Office of Technology Assessment (TAB), Berlin

Solid-State Far-UVC Roadmapping Workshop Report June 2024
Poster, 2nd International Congress on Far-UVC Science and Technology (ICFUST 2024), St Andrews

Biological threats: Going viral June 2024
Podcast guest, *Ok, Doomer! The NEVER podcast*, European Leadership Network

Mitigating the Risks from Catastrophic Pandemics May 2024
Panelist, biosecurity roundtable with Gregory Lewis and Jasmin Kaur, EPFL, Lausanne

Indoor Air Quality and Airborne Infections Mar 2024
Talk for the Global Health Hub Germany community on pandemic prevention and biosecurity, German Environment Agency (UBA) (in German)

Pandemics and Biosecurity Nov 2023
Talk and deep-dive workshops (with Janika Schmitt), seminar *Effektiver Altruismus*, German Academic Scholarship Foundation (Studienstiftung), Berlin

Biosecurity: A Technical Perspective Sept 2023
Talk, EAGxBerlin 2023

Prävention globaler katastrophaler biologischer Risiken und Far-UVC May 2023
Podcast guest, *Prioritäten Podcast* (in German)

Biosecurity: A Brief Introduction Oct 2022
Talk, EA workshop of the Swiss Study Foundation, Wichtracht, Switzerland

Biosecurity: A Technical Perspective Sept 2022
Talk, EAGxBerlin 2022

SRET Sterilisation of Viruses Aug 2022
Lightning talk, Biosecurity Founders Retreat

Viruses, Pandemics and Effective Altruism Sept 2021
Podcast guest, *The Transformative Ideas Podcast*

Scale, Solvability, Neglectedness: A Framework for Cause Prioritisation July 2018
Poster (with Max Räuker), 15th Conference of the International Society for Utilitarian Studies (ISUS), Karlsruhe

Skills

Lab & bioinformatics: High-throughput sequencing workflows (Illumina SBS, Nanopore); bioinformatics CLI tools and suites (e.g., CLC, Geneious Prime) for sequencing data analysis and phylogenetics

Biosafety & biosecurity: State-approved course §15 GenTSV for project leaders and responsible persons for biosafety

Programming & ML: Python, R, Bash, SQL (intermediate); LLM evaluations with Inspect AI

Courses: Machine Learning in R (University of Cambridge); Machine Learning (Stanford, Coursera); Bayesian Statistics, with honors (UC Santa Cruz, Coursera)

Communication: Public speaking (EAGx talks, podcasts, academic conferences, general audiences); alumnus of the Center for Applied Rationality (CFAR) programme

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Mandarin (basic), Latin (intermediate certificate)

Other Engagements

- Member of the Pandemic Preparedness & Biosecurity working group at the Global Health Hub Germany
- Board member of Effective Altruism Germany (2023–2025)
- Research mentor for MATS (2026), the Pivotal Research Fellowship (2025–2026), and the ERA AIxBio Fellowship (2026)
- Judge for the Apart Research AIxBio Hackathon (2026)
- Specialist and mentor for 80,000 Hours and HI-Med advisees
- Former Pandemics course facilitator for BlueDot Impact
- Co-organizer of the 1st Singer Symposium on Biosecurity, a two-day symposium near Oxford, UK, for early-career people working on GCBRs (2022)
- Science communication and high school student engagement with I'm a Scientist (2021, 2024)
- Former outreach support & speaker for the Effective Altruism Foundation, Berlin
- Co-founder of the Effective Altruism chapters Osnabrück and Hannover
- Member of Mensa International
- Former member of the animal rights student group Osnabrück

Personal Interests

Gamemastering for TTRPG groups, hiking, and drumming to/exploring weird music.

Publications

ReproBAIT: Can coding agents build their own biological AI tools? Oct 2026
S. Muthupandiyan, T. H. Dur, M. Walker, T. Flesch, M. Ghanem, …, **J. Götting**, …, J. Pencharz
arxiv.org/abs/2610.19810 (arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.19810)

BioTIER: A Refusal Benchmark for Targeted Biological Risk Mitigation July 2026
E. M. Marshall, P. Medeiros, P. Peneder, N. Mak, J. Kaffey, F. Rovenolt, M. Walker, S. Donoughe, **J. Götting**
arxiv.org/abs/2607.14479 (arXiv preprint arXiv:2607.14479)

LLM Novice Uplift on Dual-Use, In Silico Biology Tasks Feb 2026
C. B. C. Zhang, C. Q. Knight, N. Kruus, J. Hausenloy, P. Medeiros, …, **J. Götting**, …, J. Michael
arxiv.org/abs/2602.23329 (arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.23329)

RNA-interactome capture identifies SRSF3 as a key protein for herpesviral gene expression July 2025
C. Vogt, M. van Ham, R. Bhowmik, A. Argoetti, D. P. Depledge, …, **J. Götting**, …, J. Bohne
10.1093/pnasnexus/pgaf225 (PNAS Nexus 4(8), pgaf225)

AEF-1: Minimum Operating Conditions for Independent Third Party AI Evaluations 2025
C. Stosz, K. Elmgren, C. Foster, G. Balston, S. Donoughe, …, **J. Götting**, et al.
www.aef.one/aef-one.pdf (Technical report, AI Evaluator Forum)

Virology Capabilities Test (VCT): A Multimodal Virology Q&A Benchmark Apr 2025
J. Götting*, P. Medeiros*, J. G. Sanders*, N. Li, L. Phan, K. Elabd, L. Justen, D. Hendrycks, S. Donoughe
arxiv.org/abs/2504.16137 (arXiv preprint arXiv:2504.16137)

Solid-State Far-UVC Roadmapping Workshop Report 2024
J. Götting, V. Belenky
www.convergentresearch.org/resources/convergent/solid-state-far-uvc-roadmapping-workshop-report (Convergent Research roadmap report)

DNA viral genomic diversity data for epidemiologic and diagnostic studies 2022
J. Götting
10.26068/mhhrpm/20230921-000 (Doctoral dissertation, Hannover Medical School)

In vivo adenine base editing reverts C282Y and improves iron metabolism in hemochromatosis mice Sept 2022
A. Rovai, B. Chung, Q. Hu, S. Hook, Q. Yuan, …, **J. Götting**, …, M. Ott
10.1038/s41467-022-32906-9 (Nature Communications 13, 5215)

Molecular phylogeny of human adenovirus type 41 lineages July 2022
J. Götting, A. K. Cordes, L. Steinbrück, A. Heim
10.1093/ve/veac098 (Virus Evolution 8(2), veac098)

High genetic stability of co-circulating human adenovirus type 31 lineages over 59 years July 2022
J. Götting, C. Baier, V. Panagiota, B. Maecker-Kolhoff, A. Dhingra, A. Heim
10.1093/ve/veac067 (Virus Evolution 8(2), veac067)

Diagnostic yield and therapeutic consequences of targeted next-generation sequencing in sporadic primary immunodeficiency 2022
G. Sogkas, N. Dubrowinskaja, K. Schütz, L. Steinbrück, **J. Götting**, …, F. Atschekzei
10.1159/000519199 (International Archives of Allergy and Immunology 183(3), 337–349)

IFN-β deficiency results in fatal or demyelinating disease in C57BL/6 mice infected with Theiler's murine encephalomyelitis viruses Feb 2022
M. Bühler, S. Runft, D. Li, **J. Götting**, C. N. Detje, …, I. Gerhauser
10.3389/fimmu.2022.786940 (Frontiers in Immunology 13, 786940)

A recombinant system and reporter viruses for Papiine alphaherpesvirus 2 Jan 2022
A. Rahman Siregar, S. Gärtner, **J. Götting**, P. Stegen, A. Kaul, T. F. Schulz, S. Pöhlmann, M. Winkler
10.3390/v14010091 (Viruses 14(1), 91)

Haploflow: strain-resolved de novo assembly of viral genomes July 2021
A. Fritz, A. Bremges, Z.-L. Deng, T. R. Lesker, **J. Götting**, …, A. C. McHardy
10.1186/s13059-021-02426-8 (Genome Biology 22, 212)

Human cytomegalovirus genome diversity in longitudinally collected breast milk samples Apr 2021
J. Götting, K. Lazar, N. M. Suárez, L. Steinbrück, T. Rabe, …, T. Ganzenmueller
10.3389/fcimb.2021.664247 (Frontiers in Cellular and Infection Microbiology 11, 664247)

Human cytomegalovirus multiple-strain infections and viral population diversity in haematopoietic stem cell transplant recipients analysed by high-throughput sequencing 2021
A. Dhingra*, **J. Götting***, P. R. Varanasi, L. Steinbrück, S. Camiolo, …, T. Ganzenmueller
10.1007/s00430-021-00722-5 (Medical Microbiology and Immunology 210, 291–304)

Evaluating assembly and variant calling software for strain-resolved analysis of large DNA viruses 2021
Z.-L. Deng, A. Dhingra, A. Fritz, **J. Götting**, P. C. Münch, L. Steinbrück, T. F. Schulz, T. Ganzenmüller, A. C. McHardy
10.1093/bib/bbaa123 (Briefings in Bioinformatics 22(3), bbaa123)

A fosmid-based system for the generation of recombinant Cercopithecine alphaherpesvirus 2 encoding reporter genes Nov 2019
E. Chukhno, S. Gärtner, A. Rahman Siregar, A. Mehr, M. Wende, …, **J. Götting**, …, M. Winkler
10.3390/v11111026 (Viruses 11(11), 1026)

Other Writing

- AIs can provide expert-level virology assistance — SecureBio Substack, Apr 2025
- Careers concerning Global Catastrophic Biological Risks (GCBRs) from a German perspective — EA Forum, Sep 2022
- What success looks like — EA Forum, Jun 2022
- Where would we set up the next EA hubs? — EA Forum, Mar 2022
- Idea: Red Teaming Fellowships — EA Forum, Feb 2022
- EA Analysis of the German Coalition Agreement 2021–2025 — EA Forum, Jan 2022
- EA megaprojects continued — EA Forum, Dec 2021